GOLD STANDARD · VERBATIM DIET POSTER

NO REGULATORY BANNER — EXEMPT REPTILE
Outside USDA / TPWD jurisdiction. Husbandry per LIFE protocol.

[photo]

RUSSIAN TORTOISE

Testudo horsfieldii

STEPPE HERBIVORE — Broadleaf Greens + Hay

WHAT THIS ANIMAL IS: Steppe tortoise — Central Asia; broadleaf grazer, NOT a hay-only specie
SITES: Houston · San Antonio

3-SEC CHECK: Are broadleaf greens dominant? Is hay present?

STANDARD DIET — HEALTHY ANIMALS ONLY

Excludes sick / vet-care / special-diet animals

Covers ~95% of daily feedings. For the remaining 5%, use training and observation within sound science. Unsure — Pause. Ask. Escalate.

MORNING FEED-OUT

Broadleaf greens dominant (dandelion, collard, kale, mulberry). Grass hay secondary. Browse + weeds.

APPROX DAILY: Per posted portion chart

ENCOUNTER / ENRICHMENT PORTION

Single dandelion green or mulberry leaf for hand-feeding. Drawn from daily allocation.

CORRECT 70-80% broadleaf greens · 15% grass hay · 5% browse / weeds

Dandelion greens

Collard greens

Kale

Mulberry leaves

Grass hay

WRONG — FIX IMMEDIATELY Hay only (this is NOT a Sulcata) · Spinach · Iceberg · Daily fruit

Banana

Apple

Corn

Romaine

SIMPLE BUILD

- Broadleaf greens dominant
- Grass hay secondary
- Browse and weeds (dandelion, plantain)

PREP RULE

NOT a Sulcata — broadleaf greens dominant, hay is secondary. Trace fruit only.

MATCH THE BOWL — DO NOT INTERPRET.

No photo = feeding not complete. · No substitutions without approval. · Unsure → Pause → Ask → Escalate.

POST AT EXHIBIT · DO NOT REMOVE · SUPERSEDES PRIOR DIET CARDS

Source: AZA Chelonian TAG · Testudo nutrition standards · Verbatim Gold Standard
LIFE Diet Governance System · Gold Standard v2026.04.25 · Match the bowl. Don't interpret.